JOINT COMMISSION

Tracer Observation Form

Infection Prevention EOC Rounding AW

02/26/2026 03:14 PM

Site: 486045 Midwest Orthopedic Specialty Hospital

Program: Hospital

Observation Header	
Tracer Instructions: *No Instructions Provided*	
Observation Title:	
Observation Date:	
Total Completed Observations:	**Department:**
Survey Team:	**Staff Interviewed:**
Medical Staff:	**Unique Identifier:**
Location:	**Equipment Observed:**
	Contracted Service:
Note:	

Questions (* = Required)

Unit Tracer

1. Observe the walls. Are surfaces smooth and without cracks or chipping paint? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

MM.15.01.01 EP 4 - The hospital conducts sterile medication compounding of nonhazardous and hazardous medications within a proper environment in accordance with federal law and regulation and hospital policies. Note: Aspects of a proper environment include but are not limited to air exchanges and pressures, ISO designations, viable testing, and cleaning/disinfecting.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

2. Countertops in good repair with no chips or missing laminate ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

3. Are all areas free from visible tape/tape residue ☐ N/A

Instructions: EVS to complete daily Please place in numerator and denominator on a daily basis

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

4. Are all coverings and finishes on chairs, pads, etc. intact and not torn? Please check furniture in patient rooms, waiting rooms, and mattresses/stretchers. ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

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5. Area is free from dust and debris- please check tops of lights, booms, picture frames, crash carts		☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____	
Corrective Action:		
Notes:		
6. Are ceiling tiles free from soiling and water damage?		☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____	
Corrective Action:		
Notes:		
7. Return and supply air diffusers are free from dust		☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____	
Corrective Action:		
Notes:		
8. Is clean equipment segregated from used or dirty equipment?		☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____	
Corrective Action:		
Notes:		
9. Patient care and other clean items are NOT stored directly on the floor.		☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____	
Corrective Action:		
Notes:		
10. Observe equipment, such as IV poles, carts, beds, furniture, curtains, etc. Are all items clean and in good repair?		☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____	
Corrective Action:		
Notes:		
11. Metal equipment such as linen carts are free from rust		☐ N/A
Instructions: Daily		
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____	
Corrective Action:		
Notes:		
12. Are the bottom shelves of racks used for storage of sterile and clean supplies designed with an impervious solid material?		☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____	
Corrective Action:		
Notes:		
13. Clean and sterile patient care items are NOT stored in cardboard boxes AND outside shipping boxes are not used to store items in a clean storage room, in accordance with policy		☐ N/A

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Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
14. Is linen stored in a clean room or covered when stored in the hallway or other locations? ☐ N/A	
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
15. Are clinical areas free from staff food and drinks in accordance with policy? ☐ N/A	
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
16. Are ice machines clean and free from calcifications? ☐ N/A	
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
17. Are patient food refrigerator logs maintained and up-to-date? Are temperatures within range? If not, is there evidence that corrective action was taken? ☐ N/A	
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
18. Are sinks clear from items that can be contaminated from splashes? ☐ N/A	
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.	
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
19. Are sinks, toilets', and shower heads clean without calcifications? ☐ N/A	
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.	
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
20. Are all items within the manufacturers' expiration dates? ☐ N/A	
Instructions: Patient Food, Formula, Sanitizer, Wipes, Etc.	

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Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
21. Do clean utility rooms contain only clean/sterile items?	☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
22. Do sterile storage, medication rooms, and other clean/sterile areas have a pressure relationship positive (+) to adjacent area?	☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
23. Glucometers are clean and not soiled with blood or controls	☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
24. Are sharps containers securely mounted and not overfilled?	☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
PE.02.01.01 EP 4 - The hospital develops and implements policies and procedures to protect patients and staff from exposure to hazardous materials. The policies and procedures address the following: - Minimizing risk when selecting, handling, storing, transporting, using, and disposing of radioactive materials, hazardous chemicals, and hazardous gases and vapors - Disposal of hazardous medications - Minimizing risk when selecting and using hazardous energy sources, including the use of proper shielding - Periodic inspection of radiology equipment and prompt correction of hazards found during inspection - Precautions to follow and personal protective equipment to wear in response to hazardous material and waste spills or exposure Note 1: Hazardous energy is produced by both ionizing equipment (for example, radiation and x-ray equipment) and nonionizing equipment (for example, lasers and MRIs). Note 2: Hazardous gases and vapors include but are not limited to ethylene oxide and nitrous oxide gases; vapors generated by glutaraldehyde; cauterizing equipment, such as lasers; waste anesthetic gas disposal (WAGD); and laboratory rooftop exhaust. (For full text, refer to NFPA 99-2012: 9.3.8; 9.3.9)	
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
25. Do soiled utility rooms contain contaminated/soiled items only?	☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
26. Is PPE available for staff in soiled utility rooms?	☐ N/A
Instructions: Required PPE (Gloves, Eye Protection, Masks)	
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	

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27. Soiled utility, trash, hazardous waste, and other dirty rooms have a pressure relationship negative (-) to adjacent area? ☐ N/A

Instructions: Use the numerator and denominator to indicate the number of rooms checked.

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

28. Can staff state the wet time for cleaning of equipment? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

Isolation Precautions

29. Select a patient for whom transmission-based precautions have been implemented. Review the medical record and ask staff to describe the patient condition requiring precautions and the type of precautions that have implemented. Does the sign located outside of the patient's room coincide with the information provided by staff and the medical record? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

30. Is all appropriate PPE easily accessible to staff and medical staff prior to entering the room? ☐ N/A

Instructions: Examples of PPE include: gloves, gown, face shield, protective covering, etc.

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

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Corrective Action:

Notes:

31. Observe as many practitioners entering and exiting the isolation room as is feasible. Do all practitioners use PPE as required for the type of isolation? The denominator should include the total number of practitioners observed. ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

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Corrective Action:

Notes:

32. Discuss with staff the process for low-level disinfection of patient equipment when in isolation - including the recommended disinfectant and contact, dwell, or wet time. Is the process, as described, consistent with policy and manufacturers' guidelines? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

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Corrective Action:

Notes:

OR / Procedure

33. Are temperature/humidity levels within the proper range in ORs? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

34. In surgical/procedure areas does the staff have all hair and earrings covered? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

35. Was the sterile field prepared as close as possible to the time of use and maintained and monitored constantly? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

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Corrective Action:

Notes:

36. Are items introduced into the sterile field opened, dispensed, and transferred in a manner to maintain sterility? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

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37. Did staff setting up the sterile field verify the indicators on the sterile supplies to ensure items were sterilized? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

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Corrective Action:

Notes:

38. Observe set up of the sterile field. Were outer wrappers of sterile supplies inspected for tears, holes or any evidence that the integrity of the packaging was compromised? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

39. Were sterile solutions poured on the sterile field slowly to prevent splash back and any residual solution discarded? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

40. Did staff setting up the sterile field ensure that sterile items (including hands) were not placed below the sterile field? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

41. Are procedure room doors closed after the set up of the sterile field is completed? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

42. Do only sterile or scrubbed personnel enter the sterile field(s) after set up? ☐ N/A

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Compliant? ◯Yes ◯No	Num: _____ Den: _____
IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.	
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	

43. Is the sterility of the sterile field maintained during the procedure ? ☐ N/A

Instructions: Examples of non-compliance include unscrubbed staff walking between sterile fields and scrubbed staff touching non-sterile items.

Compliant? ◯Yes ◯No	Num: _____ Den: _____
IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.	
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	

44. Is movement in or around sterile field done in a manner to maintain sterility? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯Yes ◯No	Num: _____ Den: _____
IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.	
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	

45. Is the sterile field maintained, including items used within the sterile field are sterile? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯Yes ◯No	Num: _____ Den: _____
IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.	
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	

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46. If immediate-use* steam sterilization (IUSS) is performed, are all of the following criteria met?: ☐ N/A

a. Work practices ensure proper cleaning and decontamination, inspection, and arrangement of the instruments into the recommended sterilizing trays or other containment devices before sterilization.
b. Once clean, the item is placed within a container intended for immediate use.
c. The sterilizer cycle and parameters used are selected according to the manufacturers' instructions for use for the device, container, and sterilizer.
d. The sterilizer function is monitored with mechanical monitors and chemical and biologic indicators that are validated for use with the sterilization cycle and in accordance with the device and sterilizer manufacturers' instructions.
e. The processed item must be transferred immediately*, using aseptic technique, from the sterilizer to the actual point of use, the sterile field in an ongoing surgical procedure. *"Immediate use" is defined as the shortest possible time between a sterilized item's removal from the sterilizer and its aseptic transfer to the sterile field. A sterilized item intended for immediate use is not stored for future use, nor held from one case to another.

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

IC.06.01.01 EP 3 - The hospital implements activities for the surveillance, prevention, and control of health care–associated infections and other infectious diseases, including maintaining a clean and sanitary environment to avoid sources and transmission of infection, and addresses any infection control issues identified by public health authorities that could impact the hospital.

Corrective Action:

Notes:

47. After sterilization, medical devices and instruments are stored for less than 1 year before re-inspection and re-processing occurs? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

Instrument Integrity

48. Single use Pakistan instruments are NOT found in peel packs? ☐ N/A

Numerator: Total Number of Instruments NOT marked as "Pakistan"
Denominator: Total Number of Instruments Observed

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

49. Sterile instruments are in an open position in peel packs? ☐ N/A

Numerator: Total Number of Instruments in the Open Position
Denominator: Total Number of Instruments Observed

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

50. Instruments are free of orange/brown staining in peel packs? ☐ N/A

Numerator: Total Number of Instruments Free of Orange / Brown Staining
Denominator: Total Number of Instruments Observed

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

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Notes:

51. Sterile instruments are free of frayed tape / tape residue in peel packs? ☐ N/A

Numerator: Total Number of Instruments Free of Tape and Tape Residue
Denominator: Total Number of Instruments Observed

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

52. Sterile instruments are free of etching / other surface damage in peel packs? ☐ N/A

Numerator: Total Number of Instruments Free of Etching or Surface Damage
Denominator: Total Number of Instruments Observed

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

53. Are sterile packs labeled with the sterilizer used, the cycle or load number, and the date of sterilization? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

54. Observe the sterile storage rooms. Are sterile items stored in a manner to prevent compromised sterility? ☐ N/A

Instructions: Examples: protected by dust covers when indicated, a reasonable distance from the floor, impervious bottom shelves. Rigid containers are not stored on top of wrapped sets. Items are positioned so that packaging is not crushed, bent, compressed, or punctured.

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

55. All items in storage maintain event-related sterility and are not expired ☐ N/A

Instructions: For event-related sterility instruments should have no evidence of moisture, compromised packaging, or external indicators without appropriate color changes. Process should exist for auditing older sets that have not been used to ensure instrument integrity has been maintained. Process should exist to ensure storage times do not exceed the manufacturer's instructions for use

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

Notes:

56. Are sterile packs /blue wraps stored to maintain the integrity of the packaging (not stacked more than two high and not stored directly on an open rack with sharp edges)? ☐ N/A

Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No | Num: _____ Den: _____

Corrective Action:

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Notes:	
57. Do sterile packs/blue wraps have temperature changing tape to validate sterilization?	☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	
58. Do instrument caskets have locks with color changing indicator to validate sterilization?	☐ N/A
Compliant? ◯ Yes ◯ No	Num: _____ Den: _____
Corrective Action:	
Notes:	

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